Your current team won't get you to the next level

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Oct 20, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/nEq2RE5E_qA Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

The team that carries you from $1M to $3M/year lacks the experience to reach $10M+. Tim Luong replaced every leadership team member over 18 months to break into 8-figure revenue.

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🚧 The $1M–$3M Team Ceiling 0:00

- Tim identifies a hard-learned business lesson: the team that gets you to $1M–$3M/year is not the team that gets you to $10M/year
  - His early team members were genuinely talented and contributed significantly to reaching that initial revenue level
  - He made the mistake of trying to reinvest in them — developing them into leaders and managers — hoping they could grow into the next stage
    - This took him "way too long to learn"
  - Ultimately, those team members were not suited for operating at a $10M/year level
- What the next level actually requires:
  - More experience
  - Stronger leadership skills
  - Deeper management experience
  - Someone who already knows how to operate at a $10M/year scale

🔄 The Hard Decision: Full Leadership Replacement 0:23

- Over the course of **18 months**, Tim replaced every single person on his leadership team
  - This was not a partial reshuffle — it was a complete overhaul
  - The result: a leadership team that now runs an **8-figure/year business**
- He acknowledges this is not an easy decision to make

- Implicit tension: loyalty to people who helped build the early business vs. the operational requirements of the next stage

💡 Key Takeaway for Stuck Founders 0:45

- If you have been stuck in the **$1M–$3M/year range for a while**, the likely root cause is your leadership talent, not your product or market
  - The team may simply not have the capability to operate at an 8-figure level

    > "Most likely it could be because you don't have the level of leadership and talent yet to actually operate at an 8 figure a year level."

- The implied action: audit your leadership team against the demands of the next revenue stage, not the current one